

SPRINT 8: Consumer App – Retrospective

What went well across the ten weeks

We were able to finish all of our sprints within their designated time slots. This was achieved through assigning everyone tasks as soon as possible, most of which could be done independently, and assigning ourselves a due date (typically around Friday or Saturday).

We were also able to complete many tasks ahead of time, such as adding a light or dark theme in Sprint 7 to our frontend before it was assigned in Sprint 8, or having our backend web API give the user featured/popular movies the sprint before it was assigned.

What you'd do differently if you were starting the quarter again

Use AI agents with context from the beginning instead of mid quarter. Most of use were just asking the agent to produce code in the chats and pasting everything they need there. Sometimes it would give good results, but sometimes it wouldn't. Using agents with context produces better results in our experience.

Another thing we would do differently is to plan and divide sprint tasks more thoughtfully. This would prevent merge conflicts resulting in less work for everyone. One example I can think of is instead of dividing the work for writing/editing/deleting reviews and ratings

What surprised you about working on someone else's API and having someone else work on yours

We are learning what it is like reporting bugs on another team's API and receiving bugs back. In most of our prior projects, we were working on projects within a bubble, straying little from ourselves or our groups.

To cope with this adjustment, we've utilized their bug report sites, as well as keeping up with them through discord. Such discord communication includes the creation of a server titled "Hand-off" and "Group 4 issue triage". Not only that, but we've set up a discord webhook named "Issue Reporter" to notify us of when bugs occur.

What you learned about working with AI coding agents that you didn't know in Week 1

For one of our team members, they have exclusively used AI through websites like Gemini or ChatGPT, and they have gathered experience with using AI through Cursor and Github Copilot (on vscode). This has eliminated the need for long, lengthy paragraphs of prompt engineering.

Coding agents get significantly better at certain topics (namely front end design) if you give them "skills", the odd part is that they sometimes forget to use those skills unless you remind them to use those skills.